STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE			AU-2700
	SARPY COUNTY SHERIFF'S OFFICE PAPILLION * NEBRASKA **GREG LONDON** **SHERIFF**	DATE ISSUED 02/08/23	DATE REVISED **03/15/24**	DATE REVIEWED 02/02/25
		APPROVED: *GREG LONDON*		
CHAPTER TITLE AUXILIARY UNITS: SPECIAL WEAPONS AND TACTICS		RESOURCES NATIONAL TACTICAL OFFICER'S ASSOCIATION MODEL DOCUMENT 2020		
SUBJECT SWAT EXPLOSIVE BREACHING		CROSS REFERENCE		

I. Purpose:

The proper utilization of explosive breaching charges can be a safe and viable tactic when supporting Tactical Teams (SWAT) during the resolution of specific critical incidents. This may include:

- Terrorist incidents
- Hostage rescue/recovery operations
- Service of high-risk search/arrest warrants
- Barricaded subject/suspect scenarios
- Clearance of booby traps
- Civil disaster scenarios

Tactical breaching charges are specialized tools that are deployed in the furtherance of legitimate law enforcement functions. An effective breach includes the efficient use of explosives to achieve successful penetration or defeat of a specified target. Successful breaching techniques facilitate entry to minimize risk to victims/hostages, innocent civilians, tactical officers, and the suspect(s). These techniques may enhance tactical advantages desirous when performing specific, deliberate rescue/recovery missions or other law enforcement operations.

II. Policy:

A. CRITERIA FOR THE USE OF EXPLOSIVE BREACHING: In general, one or more of the following threshold criteria should be met to justify the use of explosive breaching charges:

1. The severity of the crime at hand.
2. The probable effectiveness of other breaching methods.
3. The risk to victims /citizens, officers, and suspect/s if other breaching methods fail.

4. The likely outcome of the entry team's failure to accomplish quick and positive entry into the intended target.
5. Overall target analysis.
6. Situations where a penetration/compromise of the barrier is desired. Regardless of whether an entry is being made at that time, i.e., Breach and Hold/Delay tactics.

III. DEFINITIONS:

A. **Explosive Breach** – A technique of employing explosive materials to create an opening through a door, window, wall, or other barriers to allow access for personnel or other tactical assets.

B. **Lead Breacher** – A member of the SWAT Team who has specially trained in the construction, placement, and firing of explosive breaching charges.

C. **Assistant Breacher** – A member of the SWAT Team who works with and trains under the direction of the Breacher, who assists with the construction, placement, and firing of explosive breaching charges.

D. **Explosive Breaching Charge**– A target-specific charge constructed with explosives and non-explosive materials to enter a structure or support other tactical maneuvers.

E. **Breachers Report** – A form used to document the use of explosive breaching charges during training and actual operations.

F. **Explosive Breacher**- A member of the Tactical team who has been trained and certified through a training course in the following topics and hands-on skills at a minimum:

1. 40 hours of instruction and hands-on skills.
2. Explosive handling, storage, safety, and construction.
3. Target analysis, charge placement, construction, and initiation.
4. Misfire procedures and Breachers Briefing.
5. Data collection, reporting requirements, and safety procedures.
6. Blast pressure, overpressure, and hazards of explosive breaching.
7. Successful completion of a written test.

IV. Procedures:

A. The option to utilize an explosive breach is at the discretion of the SWAT Team Commander or his/her designee and may be delegated in advance.

B. Explosive breaching charges shall be constructed or supervised by Certified Explosive Breachers.

C. Scouting and thorough target analysis is an essential pre-breach responsibility of the Explosive Breaching element.

D. Construction of the specific charge to be used will vary from situation to situation. It will be designed based on the known intelligence, experience, and training of the breaching team. A selection of certain pre-made charges may be on-hand and available for immediate deployment.

E. Before setting the explosive breach, the breaching team should present a "Breachers Brief" to the SWAT Team Commander, team leader, , team members, and others involved in the situation.

F. Placement of the explosive breaching charges shall be at the direction of or by the Lead Breacher or the Assistant Breacher.

G. The location and placement of the tactical team will be determined by the SWAT Team leader in consultation with the Breacher(s).

H. The Lead Breacher and Assistant Breacher have the ultimate authority to refuse to breach explosively.

V. SAFETY PROCEDURES

A. All explosives will remain in control of the designated breaching team. They will be stored and transported per applicable law to ensure their safety and security.

B. If feasible, medical support personnel should be present during missions and training events where explosive breaching operations are performed.

C. The Lead Breacher or Assistant Breacher should maintain control of the firing device at all times to prevent an unintentional detonation by other persons.

D. Dual-priming is a recommended standard procedure in all operational missions to ensure positive detonation of breaching charges. Shocktube initiation systems are encouraged. Misfires should be incorporated into routine training. Breachers will work through misfire procedures as trained. It is recommended that these procedures be outlined during the Tactical Brief or Operations Plan for the mission.

E. Safety clothing and equipment should be worn by all personnel participating in explosive breaching training and operations. This includes, but is not limited to, gloves, eye protection, hearing protection, ballistic helmet, ballistic/load-bearing vest, and boots.

F. It is recommended that personnel use portable blast/fragment protection such as ballistic shields or breaching blankets.